



The Emotiv Epoc headset reads your thoughts and translates them into action, letting you play a game just by thinking about it!

of monkeys controlling robots, people controlling wheelchairs and much more.

The technology is based on electroencephalography (EEG), in which the user wears a hat with a bunch of electrodes that track the electrical signals being given out by your brain.

Initially, the user has to program the device to understand how his brain's electrical signals fire – a process calling 'mapping'. Once the EEG cap is mapped to a certain user, scientists say it can accurately detect their thoughts.

One company using this technology in the field of gaming is Australia-based Emotiv, which is getting ready to launch its Epoc headset later this year. The Emotiv Epoc has been making the rounds of various game developer conferences and other events as a way to "game with your thoughts".

Prototypes of the device have already been demonstrated on Windows PCs. Due to the complex detection algorithms involved, there is a slight lag in detecting thoughts, making the device more suitable for use in games like Harry Potter than FPS games.

The Emotiv Epoc is currently not meant for video game consoles, instead preferring to concentrate on PC gaming. However, the company has stated that it is looking at working with major console manufacturers.

While the Epoc might not be ready for prime-time yet, the underlying technology behind it remains tried and tested. It is a viable alternative, and the scenario of controlling an entire game just by using your thoughts alone is extremely tantalising.

Apart from changing gameplay itself, the technology could also open up the field of video games to the physically disabled as well as paralysed patients.

We can only imagine... 